

ACTIVITY 1 — LEARNER WORKSHEET

Stakeholder Influence Mapping

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Role Play	25 minutes	LU1	LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation

Name	
Date	

What you are doing

Nimbus Wellness Pte Ltd, a 25-person Singapore boutique skincare and wellness brand, is three months from its 5th-anniversary relaunch. The founder has committed to a new sustainable-packaging line as the centrepiece of the relaunch story.

What you will produce: A Power-Interest map with 12 stakeholders placed and an engagement approach written against each quadrant.

The scenario

Not everyone is convinced. Retail operations worries the new packaging will raise unit cost and slow reorders. A wellness retail chain that carries Nimbus in 40 outlets wants proof the change won't disrupt supply before it commits fresh shelf space. Meanwhile a vocal community of long-time customers on social media is already asking why Nimbus hasn't "gone green" sooner.

Before the founder locks the relaunch brief, your table must map who genuinely has power and interest in this decision — and design how to bring each group along, not just announce it to them.

Role assignment

Role	Played by	Goal
The Founder		Protect the relaunch vision
Retail Operations Lead		Protect margin and delivery reliability
Retail Partner Buyer		Protect their own shelf-space risk

Your steps

1. **Set up the grid** — Draw a 2×2 grid on your worksheet or flipchart. Label the horizontal axis Interest (low → high) and the vertical axis Power (low → high). Name the four quadrants: Monitor (low/low), Keep Informed (low power/high interest), Keep Satisfied (high power/low interest), Manage Closely (high/high).

2. **Assign the three roles** — One person takes the Founder, one the Retail Operations Lead, one the Retail Partner Buyer. Everyone else at the table acts as the brand team facilitating. Role-holders answer in character for the rest of the activity.
3. **List stakeholders individually first** — Working alone for three minutes, write down every stakeholder group touched by the sustainable-packaging relaunch decision. Aim for at least eight. Working alone first prevents the loudest voice at the table from anchoring the list.
4. **Pool and split internal from external** — Combine the individual lists on one sheet. Draw a line down the middle: internal (management, employees, operations) on the left; external (customers, retail partners, investors, media, regulators) on the right. Trim or merge duplicates until you have 6 internal and 6 external — 12 in total.
5. **Interview the three roles for their real concern** — Ask each role-holder in turn: “What is your actual worry here?” Write the stated position and, underneath it, the underlying concern. The gap between the two is the point of this step — the Retail Partner Buyer’s stated position is about shelf space, but the real concern is supply reliability.
6. **Plot all 12 on the grid** — Place each stakeholder in a quadrant based on power (can they stop or change this decision?) and interest (how much do they care about the outcome?). Where the table disagrees, argue it out — the disagreement is where the learning is.
7. **Match an engagement approach to each quadrant** — Assign one approach per quadrant: Manage Closely → co-design; Keep Satisfied → consult; Keep Informed → brief regularly; Monitor → light-touch watch. Then sanity-check each stakeholder: does that approach actually address the underlying concern you recorded earlier?
8. **Prepare the debrief line** — Agree one sentence: “The stakeholder we would most easily have under-managed is _____, because _____.” Nominate a spokesperson.

Your working space

Complete every field. You may keep this worksheet and refer to it during the open-book assessment.

Step 1 — Set up the grid

Step 2 — Assign the three roles

Step 3 — List stakeholders individually first

Step 4 — Pool and split internal from external

Step 5 — Interview the three roles for their real concern

Step 6 — Plot all 12 on the grid

Step 7 — Match an engagement approach to each quadrant

Step 8 — Prepare the debrief line

Answers to the discussion prompts

1. Which 6 internal and 6 external stakeholders matter most to this relaunch decision, and why?

2. Using the Power-Interest Grid, where does each stakeholder sit — and which quadrant deserves your table's limited attention this month?

3. What is each stakeholder's real underlying concern, not just their stated position?

4. What engagement approach — brief, consult or co-design — fits each stakeholder's concern and influence level?

Reflect & discuss

Which stakeholder's position surprised you once you heard their actual concern instead of assuming it?

Did power and interest always move together on your map, or did a low-power/high-interest voice turn out to be worth listening to anyway?

If the retail partner buyer voiced hesitation publicly tomorrow, how would that change your grid?

Check your work

Every group can show a completed Power-Interest map with both internal and external stakeholders placed, and an engagement approach per quadrant that matches the stakeholder's real concern — not just their job title.